Skills Matrix

See who can do what, where you rely on one person, and who will learn what, so the team can swarm.

Manage Flow · Team Capability · T-Shaped Skills · Reduce Single Points of Failure

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

LEVELS

0 = No experience
1 = Learning
2 = Can do it alone
3 = Can teach it

1 Skills Matrix

SCORE 0-3 IN EACH CELL · SELF-ASSESSED, THEN DISCUSSED

TEAM MEMBER	SKILL 1 Discovery	SKILL 2 UX design	SKILL 3 Front end	SKILL 4 Accessibility	SKILL 5 Back end, APIs	SKILL 6 Payments	SKILL 7 Test automation	SKILL 8 Data	SKILL 9 Cloud, CI/CD	SKILL 10 Facilitation	WANTS TO LEARN
Priya	3	1	0	0	0	1	0	2	0	2	SQL for our own reports
Sam	1	0	2	1	3	3	2	1	2	0	Facilitation
Jo	1	2	3	3	2	0	1	0	1	1	Payments
Alex	1	0	1	2	1	1	3	1	2	0	Cloud, CI/CD
Mei	2	3	1	2	0	0	0	1	0	1	Front end (CSS)
Tom	1	0	0	0	0	0	1	1	0	3	Data and analytics
Ravi (new)	0	0	2	1	2	0	1	0	1	0	Payments, test automation

2 Single Points of Failure

THE BUS-FACTOR CHECK

Skills where only one person is at 2 or 3:

Payments (only Sam) · Data (only Priya)

Skills where nobody is at 3 (no one to teach):

Cloud, CI/CD · Data

3 Learning Plan

PAIR TO SPREAD SKILLS

WHO	LEARNS	FROM	BY WHEN
Jo	Payments	Sam	end of May
Ravi	Test automation	Alex	June
Tom	Data	Priya	June
Alex	Cloud, CI/CD	Platform team	Q3

4 Ready to Swarm?

- [ ] Every key skill has 2+ people at level 2
- [x] Pairing time is planned each iteration
- [ ] Experts have time set aside to teach
- [x] New joiners have a learning buddy

Next review of the matrix: start of Q3

"If one person was away for a month, what would stop?"

"What would you like to learn, and who could teach you?"

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